

Chapter 9: Ancient Kingdoms of the South

Textbook Exercise Solutions & Answers

1. Can you tell?

Q1.) Whose name did the Satavahana kings write before their own?

The Satavahana kings followed the unique custom of writing their **mother's name** before their own (for example, Gautamiputra Satakarni, Vashishthiputra Pulumayi).

Q2.) The ancient name of Kolhapur.

The ancient name of Kolhapur was **Kuntal**.

2. Complete the table by reading the map in the lesson:

Dynasty	Centers / Historical Sites
Pallava	Kanchi (Kanchipuram), Mahabalipuram
Chalukya	Aihole, Badami (Vatapi), Pattadakal
Satavahana	Pratishthan (Paithan), Ajanta, Ellora, Nashik, Bhokardan

3. Tabulate the following names as dynasties and their capitals:

Satavahana, Pandya, Chalukya, Vakataka, Pallava, Madurai, Pratishthan, Kanchipuram, Vatapi

Dynasty	Capital
Satavahana	Pratishthan (Paithan)
Chalukya	Vatapi (Badami)
Vakataka	Vatsagulma (Washim) / Pravarapura
Pallava	Kanchipuram (Kanchi)
Pandya	Madurai

4. Observe any three pictures in the lesson and write in your own words what you learn from them:

(1) The Kailas Temple at Ellora

The magnificent Kailas Temple at Ellora was carved out of a single monolithic rock during the reign of Rashtrakuta king Krishna I. Symbolizing Mount Kailas, the sacred abode of Lord Shiva, it represents the supreme pinnacle of ancient Indian rock-cut architecture.

(2) A Satavahana Coin

Satavahana coins frequently depicted ships with double rudders. This demonstrates that maritime trade and overseas navigation were highly developed during the Satavahana era, connecting western Indian ports to the Mediterranean world and Rome.

(3) The Ratha (Chariot) Temples at Mahabalipuram

The monolithic monolithic ratha shrines at Mahabalipuram, carved from solid granite boulders under the Pallava rulers (notably Narasimhavarman I), highlight classical Dravidian architecture and are recognized today as a prestigious UNESCO World Heritage Site.

5. Answer in one sentence:

Q1.) Name the ancient dynasties of Southern India.

The Chera, Chola, and Pandya were the prominent ancient dynasties of Southern India.

Q2.) After the decline of the Mauryan Empire which local kings became independent?

Following the decline of the Mauryan Empire, local provincial governors and chieftains in Maharashtra, Andhra Pradesh, and Karnataka asserted their independence.

6. Answer in brief:

Q1.) Write about the achievements of Mahendravarman.

1. Mahendravarman I was a distinguished and visionary Pallava monarch who defended and consolidated his realm against rivals.
2. He was a great patron of arts, architecture, and letters, introducing rock-cut cave temples to the Tamil region.
3. He was also a talented scholar and playwright who authored the celebrated Sanskrit farce *Mattavilasa Prahasana*.

Q2.) What is meant by Tri-samudra-toya-peat-vahnah?

Tri-samudra-toya-peat-vahnah translates to 'one whose horses have drunk the waters of three oceans'. This regal epithet honored Gautamiputra Satakarni, signifying that his imperial sovereignty extended across the Indian peninsula from the Arabian Sea to the Bay of Bengal and the Indian Ocean.

Q3.) What goods were exported from the Muziris port?

High-value commercial goods including black pepper and other spices, fine pearls, semi-precious stones, beryls, silks, and diamonds were exported in large quantities to the Roman Empire from the ancient port of Muziris (in modern Kerala).